

# THE AESTHETICS VENTURE

An orientation for Abigail · Office of the Founding Partner · 11 September 2026

## What is being built

A new company in Lagos offering premium aesthetics and plastic surgery: injectables, skin and regenerative treatments, medical dermatology, and cosmetic surgery covering face, breast and body. Three organisations are forming it together. It does not exist yet, which is the point of the work you will see: everything at the moment is about agreeing how it will be owned, governed and run before anybody spends money.

## The three parties, and why each is needed

| Party                    | Represented by       | What it brings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Medbury Healthcare Group | Dr Itunu Akinware    | The capital and the place. Funds the company, provides the premises at The Lyfe Place and the equipment, and brings the standing and relationships of an established Nigerian healthcare group.                                                                                                                            |
| Dr Chinwe Kpaduwa        | personally           | The clinical authority. A plastic surgeon trained and certified in the United States. She sets the clinical standard, writes the protocols, trains and signs off every clinician, and performs the advanced and surgical work. Her practice there is called KP Plastic Surgery and is entirely separate from this company. |
| Consult for Africa       | Dr Adebowale Odulana | Builds it and runs it. Structures the venture and its agreements, gets the company incorporated and licensed, recruits the team, puts in the systems, runs marketing and procurement, and manages the programme.                                                                                                           |

The line that captures it, and which appears in the Memorandum: Medbury is the only party that can fund and house this, Dr Kpaduwa is the only party that can make it worth a premium, and CFA is the only party whose job is to make it exist and keep running. Remove any one and there is no company.

## Where it stands

The three have agreed the ownership split at **60 / 30 / 10** in that order. A Memorandum of Understanding has been drafted, revised through several rounds of comment from both Medbury's and Dr Kpaduwa's advisers, and is now with the parties. It is a draft for review, not for signature: lawyers still have to see it before anyone executes.

## The idea underneath the numbers, which is worth understanding

The hard question was how to divide ownership when the three parties contribute completely different things. Cash is easy to value. A surgeon's reputation is not. The answer the parties adopted is a single rule applied to everyone: **value what each party brings at market, deduct whatever they are paid for it in cash, and let ownership follow the balance.**

So a party paid in full for something contributes nothing by it and earns no equity for it. A party who forgoes income does contribute, and earns. That is why Medbury waives part of the rent rather than charging it all, and why Dr Kpaduwa takes half a market surgeon's fee rather than the whole of it. It is also why CFA charges its management fee in full and takes no equity at all for managing: if it discounted the fee, the discount would become a contribution and CFA's share would rise, which is the opposite of what it wants.

## Words you will hear in meetings

| Term                  | What it means                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vesting               | Equity that is earned over time rather than handed over on day one. All three parties vest here, so nobody holds a stake for work not yet done.                                                                 |
| Tier one, two, three  | The four levels of decision. Tier one is clinical and belongs to Dr Kpaduwa alone. Tier two is the board. Tier three needs every shareholder. Tier four is everything else, which management just gets on with. |
| The Clinical Director | Dr Kpaduwa's role in the company, as distinct from her being a shareholder.                                                                                                                                     |
| The House Brand       | The company's own name, which it will own. Separate from her personal marks, which she keeps and licenses to it.                                                                                                |
| The window            | The period over which contributions of forgone income are counted. It closes when Medbury's capital comes back or after three years.                                                                            |

|                       |                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stage 1, 2, 3         | Stage 1 runs to a review in November from an existing Medbury clinic. Stage 2 opens the permanent base at The Lyfe Place. Stage 3 is growth.     |
| HEFAMAA, MDCN, NAFDAC | The Lagos health facility regulator, the doctors' council, and the food and drug agency. The company needs all three before it can treat anyone. |

## What is still open

- Three figures in the documents are still estimates: CFA's day rates, the cost of equipment the existing clinic is missing, and the rental value of the space. The last of these matters most, and the Memorandum requires it to be measured and evidenced before anyone signs.
- The shareholders' agreement and the company's constitution are not drafted yet.
- The company has no name. A shortlist is to be prepared and the three parties agree it.
- The November review is the next milestone. The parties decide there whether to proceed, take longer, or stop.

## What this means for your work

- **Minutes.** When this comes up, capture decisions and who owns them, not the discussion. The recurring questions are the split, what each party contributes, who decides what, and what happens if someone leaves.
- **The commitment register.** The Memorandum has a work plan at Schedule 2 with an owner and a date against every item. That is the spine of what should be tracked. Several items are already overdue against it.
- **Documents.** Every document here is generated by a script in *scripts/* and written to *docs/*. Never edit a PDF. If a number needs changing it changes in *scripts/lib\_aesthetics\_model.py* and every document rebuilds from it, which is how they are kept from contradicting each other.
- **Filing.** The share copies are the ones prefixed “Aesthetics Company” in *docs/*. Those are what go to the parties. The others are working files.

## Two things to be careful about

**This is confidential and commercially sensitive.** It involves the private financial positions of two people and an organisation, and a deal that is not signed. Nothing about it goes outside the office, and nothing goes to one party that was said by another. If you are unsure whether something can be shared, assume it cannot and ask.

**Some of what you will see in the files is not for the parties.** Working papers record CFA's own view of the negotiation, and there are confidential responses from the principals held separately. Those are for Debo. When you are pulling material for a meeting pack, take it from the share copies rather than from the working files.

## Where to read more, in this order

| File in docs/                                                        | What it is                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aesthetics Company - What Has Changed.pdf                            | One page. Start here.                                                                    |
| Aesthetics Company - Memorandum of Understanding (Draft).pdf         | The main document. The Principal Terms page at the front is a summary of the whole deal. |
| Aesthetics Company - A Fair Framework for Sharing (Draft).pdf        | How the ownership split was worked out, if you want the reasoning.                       |
| Aesthetics Company - Commitment and How Equity Is Earned (Draft).pdf | How vesting works and what each party has to do to earn its stake.                       |

Ask me anything on this. It is a genuinely complicated deal and nobody expects you to have absorbed it from one note.